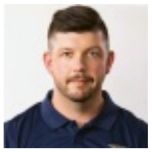
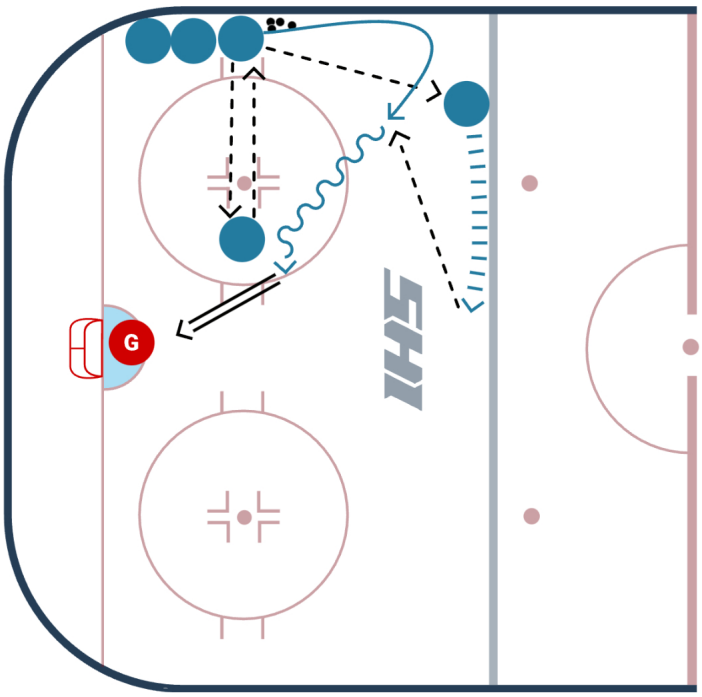
POWER PLAY FLANK SHOOTING



Time: **Station:**



The Power Play Flank Shooting Drill from Wes Wolfe focuses on power play shooting, emphasizing catch-and-release mechanics, incorporating bumper passes, and simulating game-like scenarios. It is designed to build habits and execution skills essential for a successful power play.

Setup:

- **Player Roles:**
  - One player acts as the bumper.
  - A defenseman (or forward) simulates a flank player on the power play.
  - A line of players with pucks prepares to start the drill.
- **Goaltender:** Positioned in net to challenge shots.

Execution:

INITIATING THE PLAY:

1. The first player in line passes to the bumper, who immediately passes the puck back.
2. The puck is then quickly passed to the defenseman at the blue line.

WALKING THE LINE:

1. The defenseman walks the blue line, sprinting toward the middle while maintaining puck control.
2. The initiating player climbs to simulate flank movement on the power play.

SEAM PASS AND ATTACK:

1. The defenseman passes to the flank player (now in motion).

2. The flank player uses the bumper as a simulated defender:
    - Drives around the bumper.
    - Cuts inside for a shot.
3. The bumper provides token stick pressure but does not actively defend.

ROTATION:

1. The shooting player replaces the bumper for the next rep.
2. The bumper rotates back to the line, and the next player begins.
3. Defenders can rotate after each rep, or coaches can have players get reps at all 3 positions.

Key Teaching Points:

- **Catch and Release:** Emphasize quick puck handling and release to minimize delays in shooting opportunities.
- **Positioning and Movement:** Reinforce proper flank player positioning and high climbs to simulate real power play scenarios.
- **Bumper Role:** Highlight the importance of quick puck redirection and creating screen opportunities.

Variations:

- Add defensive pressure to challenge puck movement and decision-making.
- Adjust shooting angles or use different passes to focus on specific skills.

View more content from Wes on his contributor page along with his presentation on Special Teams Practice at the Brock University High Performance Hockey Conference.